

Amorphous Research

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Abstract

An ongoing art project began with my curiosity about how to notice dust, and where the action of noticing dust comes from or forms. Particles of dust could be noticed on the surface of the desk, layered on the bookshelf, when it accumulates and bunnies behind the doors, and cultivates in some corners. Other corners in the cosmos dust bunnies into galaxies and stars. Noticing the scale and shape of dust was the beginning of an amorphous research. As I glanced away from the accumulation of dust, I began to touch dust as a dense subject matter of information that is in a constant morph. This art project is a research for an ever-fluxing question, excavating for an ever-shifting answer, and witnessing the layers in between.

The agency of dust clarified in the research as a matter to ground meaningless/full experimentation from a computational practice lens. By carving the method out as amorphous, the research journey became fictional, librating different ways in approaching dust.

Thinking with dust translated my ideas into a diagram. Drawing and writing these thoughts established a pattern of different research methods. Through researching 'A History of the Small and Invisible' (Amato, 2000) and 'Dust' (Marder, 2016), exploring the notion of dust began interweaving with multivalent subjects. The Folded Cup Diagram was the first step of the research; positioned as an observational tool towards noticing dust, it included layers of abstract, geological, ecological, theoretical, and experimental paths until the communal layer where dust is appreciated. The diagram morphed into a 3D print, changing the course of the research. With its beads of material laid down by the printer's nozzle, this thin line seemed like a finger reaching out of the printed object to direct the research from a categorical, diagrammed method to a plasticity investigative research.

Influenced by the beads' directions, I metaphorically dismantled the diagram with a rock from the Baalbek Temple. Assembling the rock in-between the sender and receiver with the act of noticing dust has extended the research into looking at objects as actant subject matter. As explained in 'The Force of Things' chapter (Bennett, 2010), Jane Bennett describes the composite of different materials and emotions as an actant. Bruno Latour describes it as something that acts and intervenes. Latour's ANT (Latour, 2005), and similar philosophies, synthesised the research methodology into sequences of more experiments, where I titled the rock Temple of Sun and began a sequence of experimentations by scanning, replicating, skewing, and holding the rock as a research method.

How is dust noticed when intervened by selected object? How to shape research by passing through the subject matter? The question will keep changing as the research semi-mutates according to different subject matter assembled in-between noticing dust. Currently, the research is situated in a semi-mutating dialogue with different topics, that will affect methods orbiting around Dust and Rock. The documentation of Amorphous research is a key aspect, that is why I created an online platform to implement development of the research. Using the browser as a tool of research, and ability to change its logic manually have added a layer of experimentation in the process of this research.

Amorphous Research Presentation poster

link to Github repo

<https://github.com/justanothersquirrel/Amorphous-Research-Repo>

link to deployed browser

<https://justanothersquirrel.github.io/Amorphous-Research-Repo/>

link to video documentaiton

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3cRMEguBam8>

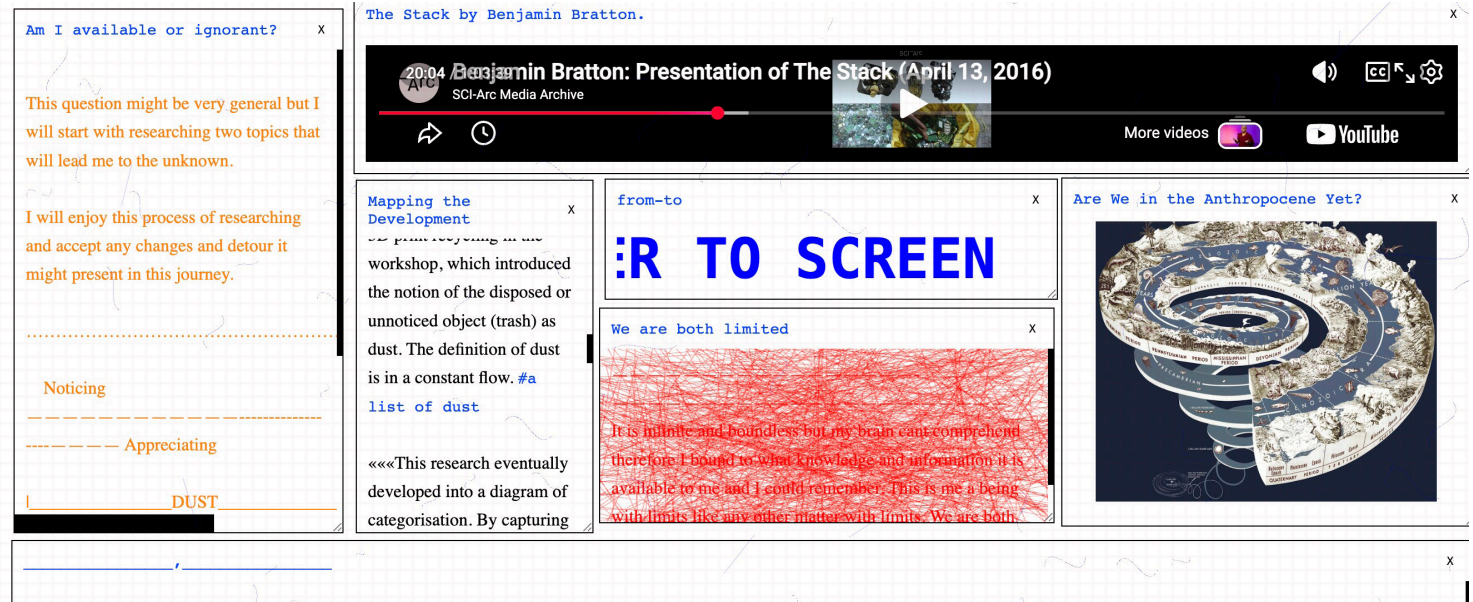
As Amorphous Research is heavily built on documentation, I thought it would be useful to use the presentation poster as a platform to expand more about the background of intuiting the final project's outcome, which is the web-server.

This consistent movement in the research has reached a layer of semi-mutation, and that's where I decided to create an archive of the process of the work. While making the HTML-based code web-server, I realised that I am building a research tool from scratch; going back and forth on my notes and research has opened more possibilities in archiving and documenting the research—adding links and animations, moving words, and sculpting a space for note-taking and applying collected data about the research project.

The website consists of links and tags, starting with the first link, which is the title, which then takes you to different sections of the developing research. Each link opens a window of related information and thoughts on the subject matter, and some windows are tagged in relation to other texts. In a way, I see this tool of information gathering as an expansion of writing notes.

The research method that is happening is becoming endless. As an ongoing experiment on this “doom” endless research, I have been suggested to look at Obsidian

Reasons for browser



to formulate and lay out my thoughts and notes to interconnect or bridge between different topics and researches that I have been passing by. Whilst I have been organising and copying my notes and thoughts into Obsidian, my research started looking like a game. Once I acknowledged this “doom” researching approach, the sense of a game started appearing as a thought to become the gate for this research to be available to other viewers.

As this is ongoing research on dust, there are still many implementations and developments that need to be explained and specified. And this is the main reason why this amorphous research should be deployed online and shared with others

screenshot of opening different windows on the desktop browser. finding different connections.

to make it “more amorphous” or add any use(ful/less) information and advice to it. It is an interactive amorphous research that concerns dust.

By manually altering the browser's internal logic, the platform creates another web-site-specific of experimentation. I created a button that chooses five random windows and opens them up, and each time the code creates random connections and interrelations on the screen. It is up to the user then to decide how to connect and separate different windows.



f the text above. I do not fully agree

Mapping Amorphous Research Development

I have used the information in the browser because it explains the process of the research since the question been asked.

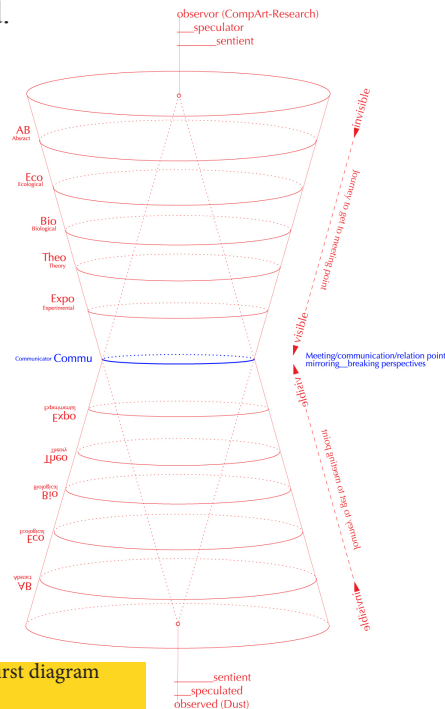


image of the first diagram drawing

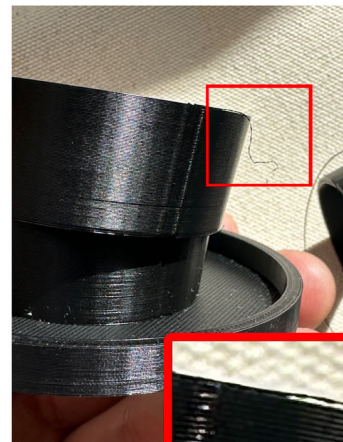
A- Configuring dust as matter to ground experiments in understanding research through computational practice.

B- The general, simple question is: How do we appreciate and notice dust? On what grounds does the act of noticing become solid and definable toward any sort of matter, in this case, dust?

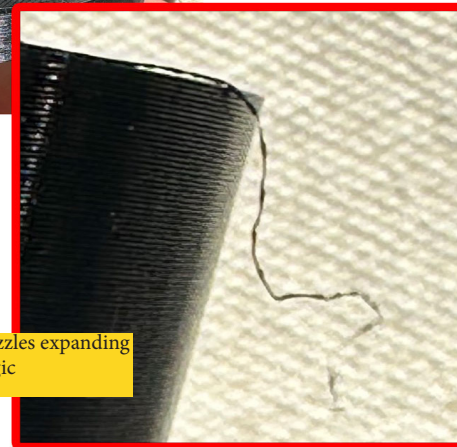
In order to notice dust I created a Folded Cup Diagram to assist my research psychology.

This diagram consists of two perspectives reflecting on each others existence as matter.

C- This research eventually developed into a diagram of categorisation. By capturing different aspects of how dust is realized, the diagram transformed into a research tool, a communal platform acting as a layer between the |obsessor|ovserver| and the |obsessed|observed|. Within the intersection of these two perspectives, the acknowledgment of both sides occurs by passing through the layers of the #Folded Cup Diagram, beginning with the abstract, geological, ecological, theoretical, and experimental, before meeting at the communal.



detail of the nozzles expanding the research logic



this research. At the same time, visualising my thoughts has increased their visibility, bringing me closer to refining the research question. That is where I decided to 3D print the diagram to clarify its dynamic of flattening the layers of research and topics.



E- In relation to this process of 3D printing, I started looking at the object as a research method located in-between the subject matter. Its dimensions, measurements, and relation to reality comprise or articulate the research method. Would this then question the act of appreciation and noticing dust? Or would it expand the act of care in noticing the observed (dust, in this case), which then intercepts a momentary question of noticing the in-between of the observer and the observed? That then relinquished the perspective points of the observer and the observed because what matters now is the in-between. . for the purpose of this research I named the experiment

D- Following feedback and a series of meetings A Thousand Plateaus (Deleuze, Guattari and Massumi, 2013), I realised that categorisation is limiting to

#Function input VERBS output. Inspired by function behaviours logic in the math online classes: injective surjective, and bijectives. (MathsIsFun, n.d.)



replicated 3D prints of the rock

F- Repeating the same object in different forms has produced different forms of research; by noticing the in-between, all matter becomes a research method, flowing and intersecting endlessly. In this situation, I have chosen a rock I found while visiting a Baalbek Roman temple. for the purpose of this research I named the experiment Temple of the Sun.



Temple of Sun original rock



Modulating the Question

With replicating the rock, the question was replicating and modulating into different forms. At this point in developing the research, the questions I asked had drawn a kinship from previous proposals and minor experimentation with the physical replication of the object as a research method.

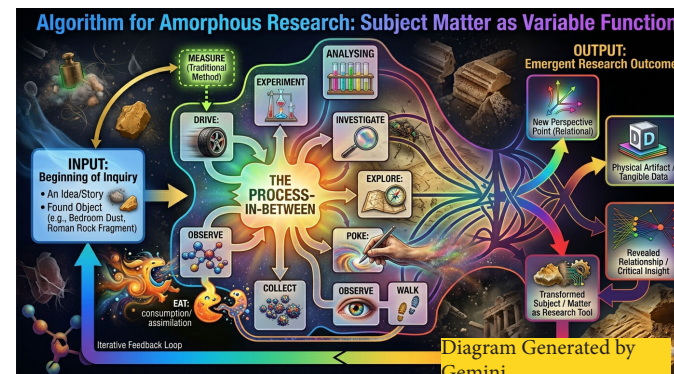
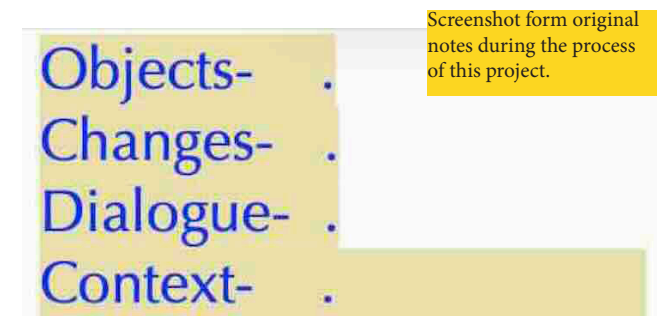


Diagram Generated by Gemini

The replication experiments, the communication with the rock, and the “in-between” have modulated the research question: From How can the in-between be noticed by travel-



Screenshot form original notes during the process of this project.

ling through the object positioned in the in-between? to What happens to subject/matter when it becomes a tool for research outcomes? and as a final question and after assembling the inbetween of noticing dust as the actant of the research method (Latour, 2005) How is dust noticed when shaped through selected object? and How to shape research by passing through subject-matter?

Semi-Mutations

My research methodology orbits the relationship between the Temple of Sun and “Dust,” leveraging their mutual agency to navigate the “in-between.” I am analysing the sender/receiver journey—the AXB model—to transform observation into methodology. By focusing on “noticing,” I explore the tension between the touchable and the visible. This trajectory passes diverse topics through this gravitational orbit, shaping outcomes through information exchange. Key theoretical inspirations include Pierre Huyghe’s Untitled (Huyghe et al., 2019), Entropy, Gilles Deleuze’s Difference and Repetition (Deleuze and Patton, 2001), and Merleau-Ponty’s The Chiasm in The visible and the invisible book (Merleau-Ponty, Lefort and Lingis, 1968). These concepts define the evolving, amorphous path of my ongoing investigation, transforming academic inquiry into an interconnected, living experiment.

